

BDI LMS — Full Deployment Cost Breakdown

Last Updated:

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App:

BDI LMS (React Native / Expo)

Platforms:

iOS & Android

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1. Cost Summary

Category	One-Time Cost	Monthly Cost (Starter)
Apple Developer Account	\$99/year	—
Google Play Developer Account	\$25 (one-time)	—
Expo (EAS)	—	\$0 (Free)
Supabase	—	\$0 (Free)
Vercel	—	\$0 (Free)
Cloudflare R2	—	~ \$5 (Free)
Firebase (FCM)	—	\$0 (Free)
Domain Name	—	—
TOTAL (Year 1 Estimate)	~\$134-139	\$5/mo (Free tiers)

2. App Store Fees

Apple App Store

Item	Cost	Frequency
Apple Developer Program	\$99 USD	Annual (auto-renewable)
App Review / Submission	Free	—
TestFlight (beta testing)	Free	—

Requirements:

- Apple ID with two-factor authentication

Google Play Store

Item	Cost	Frequency
Google Play Console registration	\$25 USD	One-time

Requirements:

- Google account
- Identity verification
- 20 testers for 14+ consecutive days before production (new requirement)

3. EAS (Expo Application Services)

EAS handles cloud builds, OTA updates, and app store submissions.

Plan	Monthly Cost	Builds	OTA Update MAUs	Key Features
Free	\$0	15 Android + 15 iOS	1,000 MAUs	Low-priority queue, 45-min timeout
Starter	\$19	\$45 build credit	3,000 MAUs	High-priority queue, large workers

4. Supabase (Backend / Database / Auth)

Supabase provides the PostgreSQL database, authentication, and real-time subscriptions.

Plan	Monthly Cost	Database	Auth MAUs	Storage	Egress
Free	\$0	500 MB	50,000	1 GB	5 GB
Pro	\$25	8 GB (+ \$0.125/GB)	100,000 (+ \$0.00325/MAU)	100 GB (+ \$0.021/GB)	250 GB (+ \$0.09/GB)

5. Vercel (API Hosting)

Vercel hosts the BDI LMS API (`bdi-lms.vercel.app`).

Plan	Monthly Cost	Key Inclusions
Hobby	\$0	100 GB bandwidth, 1M edge requests, serverless functions

Included on Hobby (Free):

- 100 GB/mo Fast Data Transfer
- 1M edge requests/mo
- Serverless Functions: 4 hrs Active CPU, 1M invocations
- Automatic CI/CD, HTTPS, CDN
- DDoS mitigation

6. Cloudflare R2 (Media Storage)

R2 stores course videos, images, PDFs, and other media assets.

Metric	Free Tier	Paid Rate
Storage	10 GB/mo	\$0.015/GB-month
Class A Ops (writes)	1M requests/mo	\$4.50/million
Class B Ops (reads)	10M requests/mo	\$0.36/million
Egress	Free (always)	\$0 (no egress fees)

Example monthly cost for a small LMS:

Usage Scenario	Estimated Cost
200 GB storage, moderate reads	~\$7.40/mo

Key advantage: R2 has **zero egress fees**, making it extremely cost-effective for media delivery compared to AWS S3 or Google Cloud Storage.

7. Firebase (Push Notifications)

Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) is used for push notifications.

Service	Cost
Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM)	Free — no limits

Firebase FCM is completely free with no message limits. This includes:

- Sending to individual devices
- Topic messaging
- Device group messaging
- Both Android and iOS

Recommendation: No cost expected. FCM remains free at any scale.

8. Recommended Starter Budget

Phase 1: Development & Testing (Free Tier)

Service	Monthly Cost
Expo (EAS Free)	\$0
Supabase (Free)	\$0
Vercel (Hobby)	\$0
Cloudflare R2 (Free)	\$0
Firebase FCM	\$0
Monthly Total	\$0

One-time costs:

Item	Cost
Apple Developer Account	\$99/year
Google Play Console	\$25 (one-time)
Domain name	~\$0/year
Expo (EAS Starter)	\$19/month
One-Time Total	~\$124

Phase 2: Production Launch

Service	Monthly Cost
Cloudflare R2	~\$1-5
Monthly Total	~\$5